

started censoring content, it's time to manually switch your PC's IPv4 DNS to 8.8.8.8. Why? Because it's a DNS server maintained by Google, which is safe, secure, speedy and reliable. It also doesn't censor anything.

- **Private search engine:** Every search engine you can think of tracks you in a myriad ways. Time to go private through some of these invasion-free search engines that don't track your data or store long-term cookies. We've mentioned DuckDuckGo (<https://duckduckgo.com>) several times before, but also spare a glance to Ixquick (<https://ixquick.com>), StartPage (<https://startpage.com>), and Yacy (<https://yacy.net>). They either search popular search engines on your behalf, while keeping you anonymous, or decentralize search through P2P.
- **Secure email:** If you're worried about American webmail companies willing to subpoena, check out Hushmail

and you're willing to walk that extra mile for the peace of mind of knowing that your online privacy levels are hitting the bar you've set yourself offline. You understand that security is a process, not a purchase. Do all of the things above, sure, but there are certain additional choices you need to make.

- **Browser:** Just start out with Tor (<https://www.torproject.org>) and start anonymizing your traffic, if your privacy concerns have risen by this point. The Pirate Browser's (<https://piratebrowser.com>) motto is "No more censorship." It is a bundle package of the Tor client (Vidalia), Firefox Portable browser (with foxyproxy addon) and some custom configs that allows you to circumvent online censorship. Be warned, by installing Tor or Pirate Browser, the chances of you getting noticed by law-enforcement agencies will only increase, because you're making yourself difficult to find online.

pads are automatically destroyed after 30 days of inactivity.

- **Encrypting communication:** PGP (Pretty Good Privacy) or GPG (GnuPG, a newer model, <https://pgptools.org>) is an end-to-end encryption software for securing emails and files. Both these services use cryptographic algorithms to scramble your data, and security analysts and Internet freedom activists believe that eavesdropping into this encrypted communication is difficult even for the NSA at times. It's a similar story with ZOHO (<https://www.zoho.com>), whose email and chat service proved a tough nut to crack. Just make sure your OS isn't pirated or infected with malware – if so, you've lost a trick.
- **Local encryption:** This may come as a surprise but TrueCrypt (<https://www.truecrypt.org>) – a file encryption service that security analysts (and even the NSA) has trouble breaking into. Using it properly does take considerable amount of time and effort, though. One of the advantages of TrueCrypt (over some of its competitors) is that it not just encrypts file with a strong algorithm, but it also makes files look like they're something else.
- **VPN:** Virtual Private Networks are great to securely bypass online censors and thereby stay anonymous (to an extent). The way it works is if you're trying to access Netflix from India, through a VPN tunnel, Netflix servers may not be able to know if you're from India or some other part of the world where Netflix is supported, thereby lifting your online entertainment roadblock. VPN services like OpenVPN, AirVPN (<https://airvpn.org>) – run by online hacktivists that reject censors and embrace privacy, and HideMyAss (<https://www.hidemypass.com>) are a few good VPN services. In the VPN world, a paying customer generally gets better service, as a thumb rule.



For end-to-end encrypted email, protected by Swiss Privacy Laws

(<https://www.hushmail.com>), a Canadian email service provider, claiming to respect "the basic human right to privacy." Like all good things in life, it comes at a price, and isn't free. If you don't want to do that, start using Mozilla Thunderbird email client (www.mozilla.org/thunderbird), as it's proven to have a great security and privacy track record. Also check out RiseUp (<https://riseup.net/en>), a secure email service that isn't subject to court orders.

2) For the mildly paranoid

You're a private person. Privacy matters to you more than the Average Online Joe,

That by itself is a red flag.

- **Social networks:** Nope, don't start laughing. Facebook, Twitter and Google+ can't offer you privacy and being the real you at the same time, and we know that all too well. What you need are alternative social networks, or redefining a traditional social network setup. Check out <https://pump.io>, an activity stream server which "does most of what people really want from a social network." RiseUp Pad (<https://pad.riseup.net>) is another "web application that allows for real-time group collaboration of text documents." Riseup claims to not store IP addresses and

3) For the severely paranoid

You can't be severely paranoid about something without being mildly paranoid. Before taking the steps given below, remember that all of this doesn't work if you ignore all of the points mentioned before. Your paranoia about online censorship and preserving your anonymity